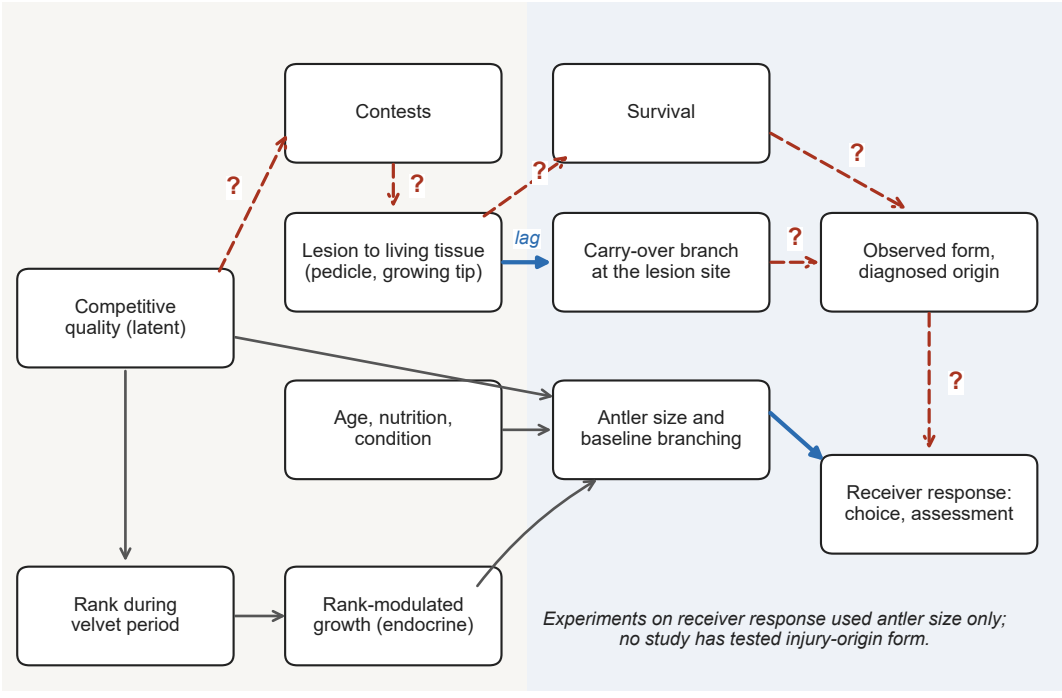

Cycle t (velvet growth, rut)
Cycle t+1 (assessment by receivers)
Contests
Survival
Lesion to living tissue (pedicle, growing tip)
lag
Carry-over branch at the lesion site
Observed form, diagnosed origin
Competitive quality (latent)
Age, nutrition, condition
Antler size and baseline branching
Receiver response: choice, assessment
Rank during velvet period
Rank-modulated growth (endocrine)
Experiments on receiver response used antler size only; no study has tested injury-origin form.
link supported by isolated experimental or accidental observations (weak evidence)
observed association; causation not established
hypothetical, unquantified or untested; ?
shading and 'lag' mark effects that cross the annual cast